muscular systems and some organs. Muscle mass and strength gradually increases as "baby fat" decrease in middle and late childhood. Throughout the middle years muscle growth tends to be extremely rapid, and they are firmly attached to the bones. Eye-hand coordination also improves and by twelve years of age, most children have highly coordinated muscles.

Bone development- As the child approaches sexual maturity, the rate of bone development will quicken in response to stimulation due to sex hormones that are produced in large quantities. The length and width of the bones increase. In late childhood, bones are hardened and reach a final mature shape.

Development of Teeth- The primary teeth that erupted during infancy and early childhood are lost from the age of six up to thirteen years. All milk teeth are replaced with primary teeth. Girls are found to have permanent teeth earlier than boys.

Brain Development- About 90% of adult brain size is achieved by age six. During late childhood, brain development includes the organization of brain functioning and myelination. Functions of the right and left hemisphere become well established during this age group.

Myelination is the deposition of fatty substance around nerve cells which helps in conduction of electrical impulses.

2. Motor development during late childhood

Children are eager to participate in activities that require large muscle movements. They spend more time in free, unstructured activities, rough games and vigorous play such as wrestling, kicking and chasing. By 6 years, most children can skip rope and begin to ride a bicycle and by 7 years most begin to perfect the movement necessary for catching, throwing, swimming and hitting ball. They develop flexibility in different parts like wrists and legs.

3. Social development

A number of changes in social development occur in the late childhood years. Besides the parents and the family members, the peer group comes to take an important place in the child's life.

- **Creation of childhood gangs-** Upon beginning schooling, children enter the "gang age" when social consciousness develops rapidly. It is characterized by interest in peer activities and an increasingly strong desire to be an accepted member of a gang.
- **Over sensitiveness-** A common outgrowth of susceptibility to social approval and disapproval is over sensitiveness. The tendency to be easily hurt by peers or siblings or parents and to interpret what others say and do as hostile, is a measure of the children's desire for social acceptance.
- **Responsibility-** Children who learn to assume responsibility at home not only make better adjustment with their peer group but also are likely to be selected for leadership roles.

4. Emotional development in late childhood

- **Temper Tantrum**

Tantrum or temper tantrum is an emotional outburst of children. It is typically characterized by crying and screaming.

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